

Restaurant Maturity Framework

Industry: multi-location casual dining restaurants. Local reference: Tampa-based Bloomin' Brands and Outback [S1]. The instrument evaluates restaurant capabilities; it does not assign a verified score to that company.

One shared scope

Define one brand, a named group of restaurants and an assessment period. Use the same scope for every answer. An operations manager should consult restaurant teams and IT, using recent operating records and dated improvement evidence.

Framework fixed for integration

The five dimension names and all 25 stage descriptions remain unchanged from the shared restaurant framework. This revision adds stronger evidence notes, confirms roles and separates the Member A deliverables from the earlier all-role preparation pack.

Assessment rules

Choose the highest fully evidenced answer while retaining relevant earlier practices. Missing evidence means the answer must be checked; it does not prove low maturity. Scores are means of question responses, not audited company ratings. A low AI score alone does not justify an AI investment.

Roles and handoff

Eduardo Donaire Filho: framework and Interpretation Guide. Cole Kostrzewa and Alifiya Shabbir: final questions and rationale. Gerald Oduro-Nuamah: HTML, scoring, radar and browser tests. B should retain the exact dimension names; C should implement the guide's profile rules and tie handling.

Requirement still requiring evidence

W5PT5 section 5.37 asks for a real Stage 1 and Stage 5 organization for each dimension. The research below supports real contrasts but does not verify all ten extreme-stage anchors. This is a remaining rubric gap, not a completed requirement. The framework and guide are ready for integration; a claim of full rubric compliance would be premature.

Course mapping: section 5.36 defines A; 5.37 requires industry calibration; 5.40 defines the five interpretation patterns. The final B file and Gerald's final HTML must still be checked together before submission.

D1 | Restaurant Data Reliability

Whether menu, sales and ingredient data can be trusted across the restaurants in scope.

Stage 1

Restaurants keep separate menu and sales records. Staff reconcile conflicting information manually.

Stage 2

Some restaurants share records or scheduled files. Coverage and checking practices vary across the assessed group.

Stage 3

The assessed restaurants use common definitions and a documented update schedule. Named staff follow a shared correction process.

Stage 4

Owners measure missing, late and conflicting records against agreed limits. Exceptions are assigned and tracked to closure.

Stage 5

Teams identify recurring data problems and change their causes. Follow-up measurements show whether the changes improve reliability.

Real-world calibration evidence

Brinker International's historical platform had reporting delays; its later Teradata implementation supported integrated restaurant analytics [S2]. This is evidence that data timeliness and integration distinguish operating states. It is not evidence that the earlier company relied only on separate manual files.

What the evidence does not establish

Neither full extreme is established. For Stage 1, verify separate records and manual reconciliation within a named scope. For Stage 5, verify recurring data-quality reviews, corrective process changes and measured follow-up. A data warehouse alone does not establish Stage 5.

D2 | Connected Guest Ordering

Whether guests can complete an order and get help across digital and restaurant channels.

Stage 1

Ordering and guest support operate separately across channels. Guests repeat details when they need help.

Stage 2

Some digital ordering journeys work, but staff bridge gaps manually. Access to order history varies by channel or restaurant.

Stage 3

Supported ordering and support journeys retain the relevant order details. Guests receive clear confirmation and a defined way to get help.

Stage 4

Owners measure failed checkouts, repeat contacts and completion problems. Teams test fixes against agreed guest-service measures.

Stage 5

Repeated tests improve ordering and support across the assessed scope. Teams retain improvements while checking accessibility and privacy.

Real-world calibration evidence

True Food Kitchen had an existing online ordering system with difficult checkout and a reported 2.83% error rate. Olo reports a 52% error-rate reduction after its storefront change [S3]. This supports measured improvement in ordering, not a claim that the earlier business had no digital capability.

What the evidence does not establish

Neither full extreme is established. Stage 1 needs evidence of disconnected ordering/support and repeated guest information. Stage 5 needs repeated improvement cycles plus accessible, privacy-aware ordering and support across scope. One successful redesign does not establish all those practices.

D3 | Kitchen and Shift Automation

How rules and systems coordinate order preparation, stock tasks and shift changes. AI is not required here.

Stage 1

Staff coordinate kitchen and shift tasks through calls, paper or separate files. Completion depends on individual follow-up.

Stage 2

Digital queues or rules support selected tasks. Handoffs and exceptions still rely on local workarounds.

Stage 3

Documented workflows assign and track tasks across the assessed scope. Staff follow a defined exception and approval process.

Stage 4

Owners monitor delays, rework and failed tasks. Alerts route exceptions to someone with authority to act.

Stage 5

Teams test changes against service, waste and staff-workload outcomes. Successful changes become standard and unsuccessful changes are reversed.

Real-world calibration evidence

Bombshell Restaurants previously scheduled staff using pen and paper, according to Fourth; later scheduling integrated sales forecasts and availability [S4]. Early Girl Eatery also had manual scheduling and payroll processes before adopting integrated tools [S7]. These are concrete low-automation historical examples within restaurant operations.

What the evidence does not establish

Historical scheduling is a Stage 1 behavior, not a full D3 company rating. Stage 5 still requires evidence across kitchen, stock and shift workflows of repeated tests, measured service/waste/workload results, and decisions to retain or reverse changes.

D4 | Restaurant AI Use and Control

Whether approved AI decisions are evaluated, supervised and improved, rather than merely purchased.

Stage 1

No approved restaurant AI use case operates in the assessed scope. Decisions use human judgment or fixed rules.

Stage 2

An approved AI experiment exists in a limited setting. Evaluation or operating controls are not yet consistent across scope.

Stage 3

At least one approved AI use case has a named owner and a documented baseline comparison. Staff review outputs and can use a non-AI fallback.

Stage 4

Owners monitor live quality, business outcomes and staff overrides against agreed limits. A documented process can pause or reverse unsafe or ineffective use.

Stage 5

Teams repeatedly evaluate model or workflow changes against the baseline. They expand, revise or retire use cases using measured outcomes and retained controls.

Real-world calibration evidence

Chili's previously relied on manual forecasting. Fourth reports that AI-supported forecasting improved accuracy by 20% [S5]. This provides a named historical non-AI forecasting example and a later AI deployment example. It does not establish that Chili's had no other AI in the assessed scope.

What the evidence does not establish

Stage 1 is supported only for the earlier forecasting task. Stage 5 remains unverified: require repeated baseline comparisons, documented review/override and stop controls, and evidence that results determine expansion, revision or retirement. Do not equate buying AI with Stage 5.

D5 | Restaurant Team Adoption

Whether managers and hourly teams can use new tools consistently across shifts and improve how changes are introduced.

Stage 1

Technology changes have no named adoption owner or structured practice. Staff learn through individual trial and error.

Stage 2

Some managers arrange training or collect feedback. Coverage and follow-up vary across shifts or restaurants.

Stage 3

A named owner coordinates role-based practice and a documented rollout. Teams have a clear way to report difficulties without penalty.

Stage 4

Owners check demonstrated skills and actual use by shift. Training and support address observed workarounds and gaps.

Stage 5

Repeated adoption reviews change rollout and support practices. Follow-up evidence shows whether teams sustain the intended workflow.

Real-world calibration evidence

Logan's Roadhouse had a training function before its 2017 LMS change, but the case describes a narrow compliance focus. The later program included named leadership, knowledge checks, reporting and measured staff/guest outcomes [S6]. This supports a stronger adoption example without treating printed training as no training.

What the evidence does not establish

Neither full extreme is established. The earlier organization is not a defensible Stage 1 anchor because an L&D team existed. Stage 5 requires explicit repeated rollout/support adjustments with follow-up evidence of sustained workflow use, not only course completion or improved sales.

Sources and calibration limits

The framework levels and profile thresholds are GROUP 2 design choices. Public cases establish examples of operating practices, not independent audits of every maturity criterion. Historical examples describe the source period, not current company scores.

Source register

[S1] Bloomin' Brands. Our Company.

<https://www.bloominbrands.com/our-company>

[S2] Teradata. Brinker International customer case.

<https://www.teradata.com/customers/brinker-international>

[S3] Olo. True Food Kitchen: simplified ordering with Serve.

<https://www.olo.com/case-studies/true-food-kitchen>

[S4] Fourth. Bombshell Restaurants customer case.

<https://www.fourth.com/case-study/bombshell-restaurants>

[S5] Fourth. Chili's Grill & Bar AI forecasting customer case.

<https://www.fourth.com/case-study/chilis-grill-and-bar>

[S6] Schoox. Logan's Roadhouse customer case. Copyright 2021; describes 2017-2020.

https://learn.schoox.com/hubfs/Case%20Study/Logans_CaseStudy_FINAL.pdf

[S7] Fourth. Early Girl Eatery customer case.

<https://www.fourth.com/case-study/early-girl-eatery>

Evidence needed to close section 5.37

For each proposed Stage 1/5 anchor, record the organization, dated scope, specific observed behavior and source. Validate both stage sentences and the relevant prior practices. Use an operating document or an interview when public sources omit controls. A hypothetical restaurant must never be presented as the required real organization.

Sources checked September 2026. Supplier case studies may select favorable outcomes and do not establish causality. No invented company baselines or maturity scores are used.